

Moti Masjid (Pearl Mosque)

موتی مسجد

1. Basic Facts

- Built by: Generally dated to Shah Jahan's reign (some sources credit Jahangir with an earlier phase later modified by Shah Jahan's architects)
- Built in: 17th century
- Cost: Not documented in available sources
- Built for: A private mosque, small and entirely built in white marble, one of three Mughal "Pearl Mosques" (alongside examples in Agra and Delhi)

2. Construction Details

- Materials: White marble, sourced from Makrana
- Architecture: Cusped arches and engaged baluster columns
- Location: Northwestern corner of the Diwan-i-Aam quadrangle, close to the Alamgiri Gate
- Craftsmen involved: Not documented

3. Historical Background

- During the Sikh period the mosque was repurposed as a Sikh house of worship and treasury, known as "Moti Mandir," before later reverting toward something closer to its original religious character.

4. Interesting Facts / Trivia

- It is one of only three Mughal "Pearl Mosques" built across the empire, the other two being in Agra and Delhi - all sharing the same white-marble, jewel-box aesthetic that gives the "pearl" name its meaning.
- Its repurposing as a Sikh treasury ("Moti Mandir") is a striking example of how the fort's buildings were reused rather than demolished across changes of empire.

5. Scenario / Narrative Moment

A small white-marble room, quiet enough for private prayer under the Mughals, later finds itself guarding something entirely different - not scripture, but treasure - after the Sikh court decides its jewel-box architecture is exactly what a royal treasury should look like.